

press feels vague and mushy. The keys have enough movement to make longer typing sessions reasonably comfortable.

Now, would I choose it for writing thousands of words every day over a proper 14-inch laptop? No. You see, the keyboard is still relatively compact, and the whole detachable setup does not have the same stability as a laptop. On a desk, I had no real complaints. On my lap, the experience is considerably less convincing.

If your idea of portable computing involves sitting at a table, the CM32 works really well. If you spend most of your time working with the computer balanced on your lap, a conventional laptop remains the safer choice.

As for the stylus, Asus includes a US1 2.0 stylus, and I am glad it does. The pen supports 4,096 levels of pressure sensitivity and can be used for handwritten notes, annotations, and sketches. The stylus can also be stored with the device and charged wirelessly.

PERFORMANCE

The Asus Chromebook CM32 uses MediaTek's Kompanio 540 processor, paired with LPDDR5X memory. The Indian variants include configurations with 4GB RAM and 64GB storage, while the higher configuration gets 8GB RAM and 128GB eMMC storage.

I would strongly recommend the 8GB version. Granted, ChromeOS is lightweight, but modern browsing is not. Open a few Google Docs, several Chrome tabs, YouTube, Gmail, and a couple of Android apps, and the extra memory becomes useful very quickly.

With 8GB RAM, the Kompanio 540 is perfectly comfortable for the workload this machine is designed around. I could browse, write, stream video, attend MS Teams calls, and move between documents without feeling like I was fighting the computer.

This is not a machine I would buy for video editing, demanding Android games, development work, or anything that needs the sustained performance you get from a Windows laptop or a Mac.



The same applies to software. Again, ChromeOS is fantastic when your workflow lives in Chrome and Google's ecosystem. Google Docs, Sheets, Drive, Gmail, and Meet all fit naturally into the experience. Android apps expand what the machine can do, and services such as Netflix and Spotify can also be used through their apps.

But ChromeOS is still ChromeOS. If you depend on desktop Photoshop, specialist engineering applications, certain development tools, or Windows-only software, this is not going to replace your main computer.

VERDICT

The Asus Chromebook CM32 Detachable is not a MacBook alternative. It is not an iPad replacement. What it is is a well-rounded portable computer for students, casual users, and anyone whose daily workload is largely browser-based.

The display is excellent. The detachable design is useful. The keyboard is better than I expected. The stylus adds value. The webcam is good, battery life is decent, and ChromeOS keeps the whole experience simple.

The single USB-C port is annoying. The kickstand takes some getting used to. There is no fingerprint scanner. The tablet software experience still has some rough edges. And I would avoid the 4GB model if you plan to keep this computer for several years.

The Asus Chromebook CM32 Detachable starts at Rs 37,990 for the 4GB + 64GB storage option in India, while the 8GB RAM and 128GB storage configuration is priced at Rs 48,999.

Whenever I didn't want to carry my Mac, the CM32 was always ready to go.

– Aman Rashid

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek™ Kompanio 540 2.0 GHz | Graphics: ARM Mali-G57 MC2 | Display: 12.1-inch 16:10 2560x1600 IPS touchscreen | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Memory: 4/8 GB LPDDR5X On-board | Storage: 64/128 GB eMMC | Camera: 5.0 MP | Battery: 42 WHrs | Charging: 45W

CONTACT

Company: Asus India | Telephone: 1800-2090365 | Email: NA | Website: www.asus.com/in/

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